Alfalfa

Used to treat:
kidney conditions, bladder and prostate conditions, and to increase urine flow; high cholesterol, asthma, osteoarthritis, rheumatoid arthritis, diabetes, upset stomach, and a bleeding disorder called thrombocytopenic purpura; also taken as a source of vitamins A, C, E, and K4; and minerals calcium, potassium, phosphorous, and iron

At high doses interacts with: blood thinners, birth control, estrogen pills, immunosuppressants, medications that increase sensitivity to sunlight, and will lower blood sugar levels

Ashwagandha Root

Used to treat:
arthritis, anxiety, bipolar disorder, attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (ADHD), balance, obsessive-compulsive disorder (OCD), trouble sleeping (insomnia), tumors, tuberculosis, asthma, a skin condition marked by white patchiness (leukoderma), bronchitis, backache, fibromyalgia, menstrual problems, hiccups, Parkinson's disease, under-active thyroid (hypothyroidism), and chronic liver disease. It is also used to reduce side effects of medications used to treat cancer and schizophrenia. Ashwagandha is used to reduce levels of fat and sugar in the blood.

Ashwagandha is also used as an "adaptogen" to help the body cope with daily stress, and as a general tonic.

Some people also use ashwagandha for improving thinking ability, decreasing pain and swelling (inflammation), and preventing the effects of aging

At high doses interacts with: immunosuppressants, sedatives (benzodD/CNS), may increase effectiveness of thyroid hormones

Burdock Root

Used to:
increase urine flow, kill germs, reduce fever, and detoxify blood; also used to treat colds, cancer, anorexia nervosa, gastrointestinal (GI) complaints, joint pain (rheumatism), gout, bladder infections, complications of syphilis, and skin conditions including acne and psoriasis; also used for high blood pressure, “hardening of the arteries” (arteriosclerosis), and liver disease.

Some people apply burdock directly to the skin for wrinkles, dry skin (ichthyosis), acne, psoriasis, and eczema

At high doses interacts with: blood thinners by slowing clotting naturally; also reduces blood sugar

Chamomile

Used to treat:
anxiety, insomnia, allergies, stomach ulcers, eczema, diabetes, wound healing

At high doses interacts with: blood thinners, as it is a natural blood thinner, and may lower blood pressure slightly

Dandelion Root

Used to treat:
tonsillitis, kidney & bladder infections, UTIs, hearth failure, upset stomach, eczema, constipation, loss of appetite

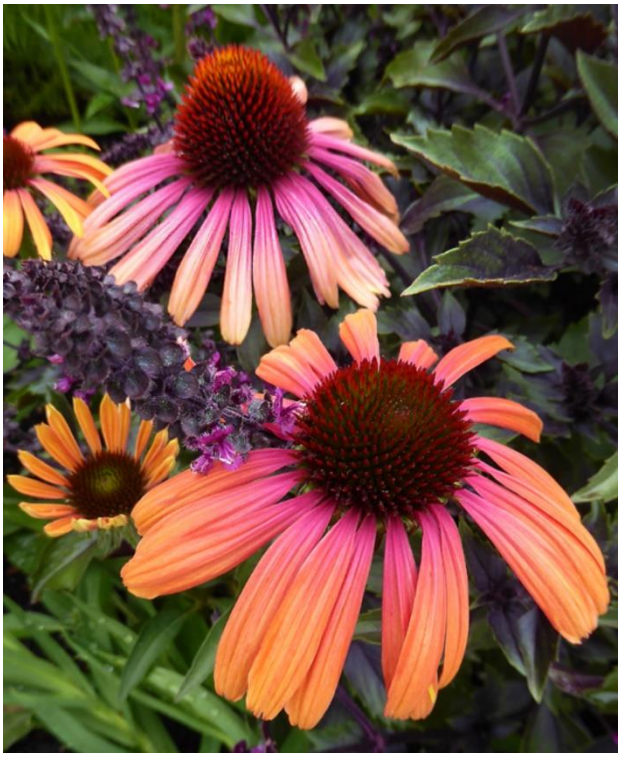
Some people apply dandelion directly to the skin for acne, psoriasis, and eczema

At high doses interacts with: some antibiotics, lithium, medications changed by the liver (Cytochrome P450 1A2 (CYP1A2) substrates) and Glucuronidated Drugs, and water pills

Dong Quai

Used to treat:
joint pain, PMS symptoms, menopausal symptoms, psoriasis

At high doses interacts with: anticoagulants and blood thinners



Echinacea

Used to treat:
common cold symptoms, anxiety, HPV, flu, low white blood cell count, tonsillitis, ADHD, bloodstream infections (contains anti-microbial properties), cold sores, hay fever, migraines, rheumatoid arthritis, strep infections, syphilis, typhoid, UTIs

At high doses interacts with: caffeine breaks down slower; medications that are changed by the body (Cytochrome P450 3A4 (CYP3A4) substrates) or liver (Cytochrome P450 1A2 (CYP1A2) substrates), immunosuppressants, and may increase the effects & side effects of some sedatives

Eleuthero Root

Used to treat:
common colds; stress and fatigue, as an adaptogen, and increases nervous system function; also known to be high in antioxidants; known to act as a diurectic

At high doses interacts with:

Increases the effects of alcohol; lithium, sedatives, blood thinners, and medications that are changed by the liver; dosages of diabetes medications may need to be adjusted

Ginger Root

Used to treat:
nausea & vomiting (particularly that caused by drugs used to treat HIV/AIDS); menstrual cramps; morning sickness; osteoarthritis; diabetes; migraine headaches; sinus, throat, and breathing problems

At high doses interacts with:
may slow blood clotting and interact with blood-thinning medications (Warfarin, Marcoumar, etc) or medications used to treat high-blood pressure and high blood-sugar, and may increase effects of Losartan

Ginkgo Biloba

Used to treat:

Anxiety, symptoms of dementia (especially if symptoms are caused by atherosclerotic vascular disease), leg pain caused by clogged arteries, PMS symptoms, schizophrenia, pulmonary hypertension, stroke, tardive dyskinesia (caused by antipsychotic medications), and dizziness/vertigo

At high doses interacts with:

- *May increase blood pressure when combined with Hydrochlorothiazide*
- *Increases the effects of blood thinners, BuSpar, Prozac, diabetes medications, and drugs that increase the chance of having a seizure*
- *decreases the effects of Xanax, Sustiva (HIV medication), and medications used to prevent seizures*
- *affects speed that the body breaks down medications that are changed by the liver (Prilosec, and Cytochrome substrates)*
- *combining with St. John's Wort and Prozac occasionally results in "hypomania"*
- *an antidepressant called Desyrel (trazodone)*

Hibiscus

Used to treat:
high blood pressure, high cholesterol, and to prevent bladder, kidney, and UT problems

At high doses interacts with:
(may increase how quickly the body gets rid of acetaminophen)

Lavender

Used to treat:
anxiety, depression, menstrual cramps, pain after surgery

Known to increase effectiveness of sedatives, causing too much sleepiness

Lemongrass

Used to treat:
high blood pressure, vomiting, migraines, diabetes, inflammation, exhaustion, intestinal cramps

no known interactions

Lungwort

Used to treat:

Breathing conditions, stomach and intestinal conditions, kidney and UT conditions, fluid retention, tuberculosis, and topically-used to treat wounds

no known interactions

Lotus Leaf

Used to treat:

Anxiety, bad breath, bleeding, diarrhea, digestion problems, fever, liver health, skin conditions, sore throat, cough

known to lower blood sugar levels

Mullein

Used to treat:

Ear infections, wounds, hemorrhoids, colds, flu, asthma, diarrhea, migraines, gout, tuberculosis, pneumonia, croup, cough, sore throat, and bronchitis

no known interactions

Nettle

Used to treat:
allergies, anemia, asthma, lung congestion, diabetes and other endocrine disorders, internal bleeding, kidney stones, UTI, osteoarthritis, stomach ailments, rash, eczema, wound healing

Also used to prevent signs of aging, and for blood purification

At high doses interacts with: blood thinners, Lithium, some sedatives, and will decrease blood sugar and blood pressure

Passionflower

Used to treat:
anxiety & migraines

Known to increase effectiveness of sedatives, causing too much sleepiness

Purple Tulsi

Used to treat:
anxiety, diabetes, high cholesterol, common cold, flu, asthma, bronchitis, headaches, earache, upset stomach, insomnia, heart disease, tuberculosis, malaria, mercury poisoning, ringworm, and used to make an antidote for snake and scorpion bites

At high doses interacts with: blood thinners, as it is a natural blood thinner

Rooibos

(Green is unfermented & Caffeine-free)

Used to treat:

Breathing problems, digestive problems, and skin conditions

- Contains more antioxidants than any other known individual plant, strengthening immune the immune system & heart muscles
- Strengthens bones, teeth, and hair
- Often used as a skin cleanser
- Often used to balance blood sugar and reduce insulin-resistance

no known interactions
(Red rooibos contains caffeine)

Skullcap

Used to treat:
anxiety, seizures, insomnia, stroke, and spinal trauma

no known interactions

St. Johns Wort

Used to treat:
depression and mood stabilization, somatization disorders, wound healing

At high doses interacts with:

- *Known to increase the speed of the body's breakdown and getting rid of certain medications, including Xanax, Elavil, birth control pills (breaking down estrogen), immunosuppressants like Neoral and Sandimmune, Camptosar, HIV/AIDS medications (NNRTIs and Protease Inhibitors), Pamelor, Luminal, Dilantin, Tacrolimus, Gleevec, various narcotics, anti-coagulants, and Cytochrome substrates*
- *Increases serotonin in the brain, and may produce too much when combined with Pondimin, Demerol, Serzone, Paxil, Talwin, Zoloft, Ultram*
- *May decrease how much Digoxin is absorbed by the body*
- *Known to increase sensitivity to sunlight when taken with Aminolevulinic acid*